Travel Agents: Taiwan Food Tour

A crowded market of rival agencies — a warm Taiwan food-tour scrum

Travel Agents: Taiwan Food Tour — Rules

The Job

Somewhere on this island, the greatest street-food tour ever run is waiting to be booked. You intend to book it first — and so does every other agency in town.

You're a travel agent. On paper it's the most wholesome job going: show a busload of hungry visitors the best stalls in Taiwan and send them home glowing. In practice you and your rivals run it like a demolition derby — elbows out, engines gunning, three agencies descending on the same beef-noodle cart at once.

One eating day, dawn to dusk: a Taipei breakfast at first light, the last train south when the neon comes on. Win the island's most beloved stalls onto your tour — every vendor happily goes with whoever's driving the biggest, hungriest crowd — line up your bookings, and out-hype the rival agents circling the very same bowl of noodles.

Complete the most tours and sell the most tickets before that last train, and the island crowns you its finest food-tour agency.

Elbows out on your rivals. Never on Taiwan. Now floor it.

Rival travel agencies chase the same food stalls through one eating day. Ride between four regions, gather ingredients, and pile Followers on the stalls you want: win a stall by drawing the biggest crowd and it joins your tour, making the next one cheaper. Score the tours you

complete and the vendors you win before the last train to be Top Agent.

> These are real Taiwanese dishes and night markets — celebrated with care. Eat them with a grin.

3–6 players · 30–45 min

Meet the Agents

Pure flavour — nothing to learn here. Each agent's actual ability and flaw live on their board and in The six agents near the end. Pour a tea and enjoy the introductions.



The Old Councillor 里長伯

> "Why trust Google Maps when the whole neighbourhood has my number?"

Need a reservation? He knows the owner.
Need a shortcut? He built it.
Need directions? Three aunties have already argued about the best route before you've finished asking.

The Old Councillor has spent so long looking after his neighbourhood that the neighbourhood now looks after him. Every market greets him like a returning celebrity. Stall owners wave him over, locals quietly slip today's freshest ingredients into his bag, and somehow he hasn't paid full price for lunch since 1998.

If your tour stays close to home, you'll eat like royalty.
If it leaves··· well··· now you're just another tourist.

The Homebody 媽寶



> "You call it over-packing. Mum calls it being prepared."

His mother packed "a few snacks."
The backpack now weighs more than he does.

Every journey begins with enough dumplings, tea eggs, fruit, drinks and emergency pineapple cakes to survive crossing the Pacific. Halfway through the trip he's somehow collected even more food than he started with.

People laugh.
Until they realise he's the only guide who never wastes time shopping because Mum already thought of everything.
She probably packed something for you too.



The Big Eater 大胃王

> "I've personally taste-tested the entire island. More than once."

Her tour has one simple guarantee:
If it's delicious, you'll eat it.

Breakfast becomes second breakfast.
Second breakfast becomes an "important cultural tasting."
Lunch somehow lasts until dinner.

By sunset everyone's carrying food babies and questioning their life choices while she's cheerfully asking, "Dessert?"

She's personally inspected every famous stall in Taiwan.
Several times.
For quality assurance, obviously.

The Influencer 網紅

> "Tomorrow's biggest food trend starts wherever I point my camera."



By the time you've discovered a hidden gem…
…she's already uploaded it.
By the time you've posted your lunch…
…she's moved onto dinner.

Entire markets panic when they see her ring light appear over the horizon because they know what's coming next: Twenty thousand hungry followers.

She doesn't chase trends.
She accidentally causes them.



The Big Boss 老大

> "Funny thing… everything always works out better when I'm around."

Nobody's quite sure what he actually does.
They just know everybody knows him.

The queue mysteriously speeds up.
The best table suddenly becomes available.
The vendor insists you try the expensive seafood "on the house."

Nobody argues.
Nobody asks questions.
Everyone simply agrees that Big Boss's tour should probably go first.
Just… seems easier that way.

The Globetrotter 阿嬤



> "Keep up if you can, dear — I already booked tomorrow."

She claims she's "slowing down."
Nobody has ever witnessed evidence.

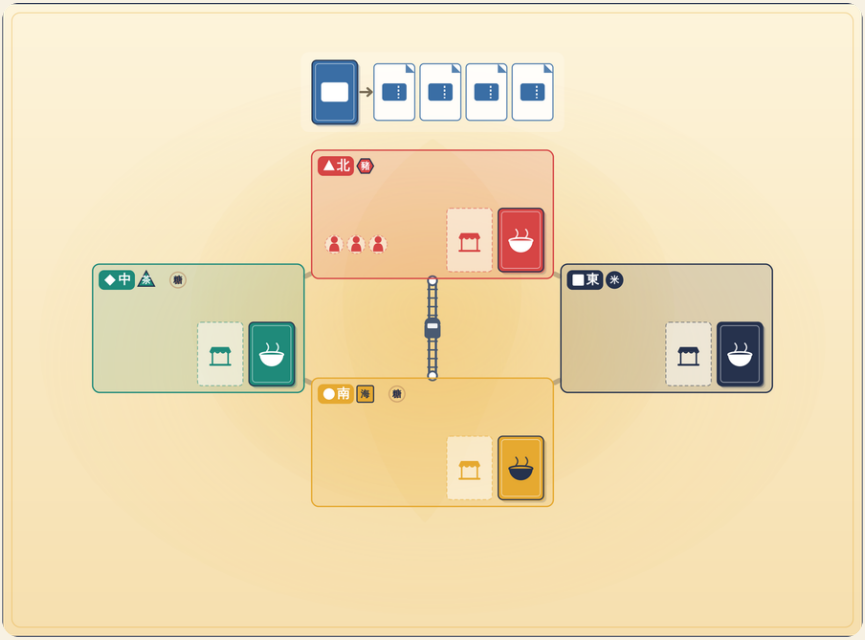
One minute she's buying breakfast in Taipei.
Five minutes later she's waving from Tainan.
By lunchtime she's somehow already eaten in Kaohsiung and is recommending dessert in Hualien.

Nobody knows how.
Nobody asks.
At this point people simply assume Taiwan rearranges itself to make life easier for Grandma.

1. What you're going for

You score two ways, tallied once at the last train: the full value of every tour (Booking) you complete, plus the printed points on every vendor you win. Tours pay far more — your main path; won vendors are a steady bonus. A Booking is a little tour you promise to run — three breakfast stalls, a ★ marquee name. Followers never score; vendor points are small on day stalls, big on night trophies (§5). Most points is Top Agent (§9).

2. Setup



> the shared board: four regions in a ring, each with its vendor slots and market deck.

Everything sits on one shared board, readable from any seat. Everyone starts in Taipei (North).

- The map — four regions in a ring: North 北 · Central 中 · South 南 · East 東. Ring-neighbours are linked; the HSR also links North and South directly.
- Ingredient markets — each region has a face-down market deck. Split each into DAY and NIGHT piles; shuffle the DAY into place, set the NIGHT aside for dusk.

- Vendor stalls — fill the face-up slots from each region's DAY vendor deck (counts below); set the NIGHT vendor decks aside for dusk.
- Booking decks — at 3 players, first set aside the seven tours marked 4–6 (they need more stalls than a 3-player game supplies). Shuffle the rest into the 開團 tour supply: the ⟳ any-time tours can be booked from the start and worked on all game, while the ☀ day tours come out by day and the ☾ night tours at night (see the setup chart for sizes). Deal a face-up Booking row to start.
- Followers — take your full pool in your colour (6; the Influencer 網紅 owns 8): put 2 on your board, the rest in your own supply.
- Each player takes a character board (read its ability and flaw aloud), a pawn in Taipei, an empty Larder face-up, and their COMPLETED 成團 and CANCELLED 取消 pile markers.

There are deliberately fewer stalls than agents — so you'll collide over them. First player is whoever ate street food most recently, then clockwise; the Influencer 網紅 takes the last seat.

3. Your turn

Take ONE action. Then, if your Larder holds more than 7 ingredients, discard down to 7.

- MARKET RUN (where you stand) — flip the top 3 of this region's local market. Any event fires now (§7), then discards. Keep 2 ingredients (the Big Eater 大胃王 keeps 3).
- CONVENIENCE STORE (anywhere) — flip the top 1 of any market: take the ingredient, or its event fires.

- TRAVEL — move to a neighbour (or North↔South by HSR), then grow your crowd: 1 follower, supply → your board. Travelling earns no ingredient — only the Homebody 媽寶 sources on a Travel.
- PROMOTE (with a vendor here) — place up to 2 followers from your board onto stall(s) here, stacked or spread (§4).
- SIGN UP a vendor (with it) — win a stall you've drawn the biggest crowd for (§5).
- BOOK a tour — take a Booking into your hand (§6).

> Greedy Grab. On a Market Run or Convenience Store, keep one extra ingredient — send 1 follower back to your supply (the crowd tuts and drifts).
>
> Characters bend the rules. Each board has one ability and one flaw for that player alone; where a board disagrees with these rules, the board wins. Some agents are flaw-free by design.

4. Followers — your crowd

Followers are the hype you pile on a stall — never in hand, always in full view. Each sits in one of three places — your supply (un-rallied), your board (rallied), or on a stall (committed) — and flows supply → board (grow, on Travel) → stall (Promote), then resolves on a win or loss (§5). You can never commit more than the pool you own.

5. Signing up a vendor — the biggest crowd wins

A face-up vendor goes to whoever draws the biggest crowd for it — provided that crowd is big enough to fill the stall. To sign up a vendor you stand with:

1. draw the biggest crowd — hold strictly more of your followers on it than any single rival, an outright plurality (a tie claims nothing; the Big Boss 老大 alone wins by matching);
2. meet its crowd-floor — have at least the stall's printed minimum crowd of your own followers on it (1 at a day stall, 2–3 at a night trophy, 4 at an ★ apex): even unopposed, a thin crowd can't claim it;
3. pay its ingredients, minus your region discounts (the crowd decides only who pays — there is no follower cost).

Take it onto your tour and complete any Booking it satisfies (§6). Your followers come home to your board; each loser's scatter to their own supply — the whole cost of losing. Leave the slot empty for now.

A tie just blocks. Level for the lead (no Big Boss present)? None may claim; the crowds ride — Promote again to break it, or walk away and leave them.

Stalls are scarce. A claimed or emptied slot stays empty until the round's-end refill, and a stall no one queues at eventually sells out (§8) — a region may have only one.

Day stalls are the engine; night stalls are the prizes. A day food stall is cheap and scores little but carries a region icon: each icon you hold makes that region's ingredients 1 cheaper to sign up, and they stack — the ramp you build over breakfast. Night stalls carry no icon —

pricey, high-scoring trophies (some want two regions' ingredients) you afford only because of that day engine. Drinks carry no icon.

> Trending 爆紅. An event can drop a Trending marker on a stall; win it and your crowd grows +1 — it went viral. The printed ★ apex stalls are a separate, permanent thing — a region's top table.
>
> Rave Reviews 好評. The first time you complete your 2nd tour, grow your crowd +1; at your 4th, take 1 ingredient of choice and your next sign-up costs 1 less. Once each, per player.

6. Bookings — your tours

A Booking (開團) is a tour you line up to run. Hold at most 3. There are three kinds, told apart on the card:

- ⟳ any-time (most tours) — finish it any time before the last train; it never cancels at dusk. The safe, default line.
- ☀ day — must be finished before dusk or it's cancelled. Riskier, so it pays a little more.
- ☾ night — a night target, finished by the last train.

Book a tour is one action, taken ONE of two ways:

- from the row — take one card from the face-up Booking row into your hand, then refill the row; or
- Pot-Luck (隨緣開團) — decline the whole row and draw the top of the current Booking deck blind (DAY deck by day, NIGHT at night). You keep it unseen; the row is not refilled — use it when nothing in the row suits you.

- Complete it (成團). The moment your won vendors satisfy a held Booking, flip it to your COMPLETED 成團 pile — it scores its full value, nudges your Tours-Completed meter, and frees a hand slot.
- Cancel it (取消). At your 3-Booking limit and want a new one — or holding a Pot-Luck tour that doesn't fit? Cancel a held Booking into your CANCELLED 取消 pile: a flat −1 at scoring.

7. Markets & events

Each region's market holds its foods plus a few events, mostly small hazards. Working a market — a Market Run or a Convenience Store — fires any event you flip, at once. An event on a Travel does nothing (only the Homebody 媽寶 draws then).

- Hazards tax or delay — they never take what you already hold, nor cost a whole turn.
- Boons hand out an ingredient, grow your crowd, or send a stall Trending.

> Who an event hits — read from the region the card came from: ⦿ You · ⬢ This region (everyone there) · ➤ Next door (a neighbour). At a Convenience Store you may be elsewhere, so ⬢ can land on a rival — not an attack, just the island living its day.
>
> 排班保養 Scheduled Maintenance (island-wide — its own banner). The HSR is down for everyone: until the start of your next turn, North and South aren't linked — travel the long way round the ring. Then it reopens. (The Globetrotter 阿嬤 is immune.)

8. The day-clock — dusk & the last train

It's one eating day, and the vendors are the clock: when the day's stalls are gone the night's begin; when those are gone, it's the last train home. The Booking decks aren't the clock (just your tour supply), and the market decks (ingredients & events) reshuffle and keep coming — only the vendors run out.

- Daytime 白天 — the 18 daytime vendors: cheap engine-seeds. Build your ramp on them.
- 黄昏 DUSK — the moment the day vendors are all gone (claimed or sold out): finish the current turn, then flip to night — bring the night vendors and markets online and deal a fresh Booking row from the NIGHT deck. Keep your Larder and Bookings.
- Night Market 夜市 — the 12 nighttime vendors (11 unique + 1 duplicate): pricey no-icon trophies, fought-over, one ★ apex per region.
- 末班車 LAST TRAIN — the moment the night vendors are all gone: finish the current round so everyone has had equal turns, then the game ends.



the Closing-Time die 關門.

The Closing-Time die 關門. A stall left too long closes — and closing time comes faster after dark. **By day**, track rounds on the board's **1·2·3 clock** and roll the die after round **L** for your count (**2** at 3 players, **3** at 4–6 — the setup chart says which), then reset the clock. **By night, it's closing time every round** — roll the die at the **end of every night round** (a stall shuts each round). Four faces are regions (北/中/南/東), two are **blank** (a reprieve). A region face **closes that region's oldest face-up stall** — even one with a crowd on it: the stall is gone (not reshuffled), and **everyone's followers on it go home to their boards, kept** — no one loses a contest, the die just called time. A blank, or a region with no stall to close, does nothing.

At each boundary (DUSK and the last train). First break any still-**tied** stall — to **most followers, then earliest committer** (paying if able); losers scatter to their supply. Then followers on **unclaimed** stalls return **home to their boards**. At **DUSK**, any unfinished **☀ day** tour you hold is **cancelled** (flat **−1**); your any-time and night tours carry on. **At the last train**, every tour still unfinished in hand is cancelled the same way.

9. Scoring

Total each player once — two tracks added together:

- + the full value of every Booking in your COMPLETED 成團 pile.
- + the printed points on every vendor you won.
- −1 for every Booking in your CANCELLED 取消 pile (flat, whatever its value).

Followers score nothing. Most points is Top Agent; ties break to most vendors, then most regions covered, then fewest cancelled Bookings.

The six agents

Everyone plays the same game with one twist. Each board states its agent's exact ability and flaw; in short:

- The Old Councillor 里長伯 — name one home region; while there, start each turn drawing 1 ingredient from any market, free (neighbours look after their beloved local); away, it sleeps.
- The Homebody 媽寶 — sole on-the-move sourcer: on a Travel, draw the top 2 of the region you left and keep both (event whiffs).
- The Big Eater 大胃王 — on a Market Run, keep all 3 (may grab a 4th, but send 1 follower back to your supply). Flaw: hazards fire twice on his Market Run.
- The Influencer 網紅 — a deeper crowd: 8 followers, not 6. Flaw: takes the last seat.
- The Big Boss 老大 — he wins ties (need only to match the biggest crowd).

- The Globetrotter 阿嬤 — her Travel reaches any region in one action; immune to Scheduled Maintenance. Each trip tires her crowd: 1 follower back to supply.

FAQ

- A market or Booking deck runs out. Reshuffle a market's discard — ingredients and events never leave the game. The vendor and Booking decks never reshuffle: the vendors are the clock and must run out (§8); an emptied Booking deck just stops refilling its row (you've seen all the tours) — that ends nothing.